

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 4
♥ J 9 8 5
♦ Q J T 5
♣ J T

♠ A J

♥ K Q 4 3

♦ A 7 3

♣ K 6 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K T 7 2

♥ T 6

♦ 9 8 2

♣ Q 9 4 3

♠ 8 6 5 3

♥ A 7 2

♦ K 6 4

♣ A 8 7

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

[showcards W:S2]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠2, dummy played the ♠3

Play the ♠Q. This is a perfect example of why you should USUALLY play Third-hand-high.

If you do not put your ♠Q on this trick declarer will get an undeserved winner with his ♠J. In this Deal it will be his ninth trick. Play Third-hand-high and he will go down, otherwise he will make his contract.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K T 7 4

♥ T 4

♦ 9 5 3

♣ A Q J 3

♠ 2

♥ A 8 7 6 2

♦ K 8 4

♣ T 8 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q J 8 6 3

♥ K 3

♦ Q T 7

♣ K 6

♠ 9 5

♥ Q J 9 5

♦ A J 6 2

♣ 9 7 4

West

North

East

South

3 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

trick. If you allow declarer to win the first trick he will pull trumps and discard two red losers on dummy's ♣ and make an overtrick.

[showcards W:HQ]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥Q, dummy played the ♥4

Play the ♥A. You dare not play low for fear declarer might win a singleton ♥K.

And when you win the first trick, (the ♥K does NOT fall), you have to decide what to do next. Do not just return the suit like a robot since it is obvious that you have no more ♥ winners and you surely won't win any ♣ tricks.

You need to switch to a ♦, and the ♦4, (low from an honor) is recommended.

Played this way you will defeat the contract by one

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

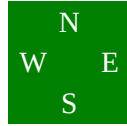
♠ J 5 3
 ♥ Q T 6
 ♦ K 6 2
 ♣ A T 6 4

♠ K 9 8

♥ A 8 5

♦ Q J 9 4

♣ 9 7 3



♠ Q 7 4 2

♥ 9 7 4 3

♦ 8 7

♣ Q J 2

♠ A T 6

♥ K J 2

♦ A T 5 3

♣ K 8 5

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT		1NT

All Pass

3NT by South
 which would be too bad for your side.

[showcards W:C4]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♣4, dummy played the ♣3

Third-hand-high is usually a good plan to follow, certainly that is true in this deal. But that doesn't mean you should blindly play your HIGHEST card, rather you should play the LOWEST of high-equals.

In other words, in this case you should play the ♣J, which is equal to the ♣Q.

If instead you play the ♣Q, figuring it makes no difference, you'd be right that it makes no difference to you. But partner would then assume that it is declarer with the ♣J, and when he obtains the lead with the ♦K he will be unlikely to lead another ♣,

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 9 5
 ♥ A K J 9 7 2
 ♦ 8
 ♣ 9 7 3

♠ Q 8 7 3

♥ T 5

♦ A 5 4 2

♣ 8 4 2



♠ J 6 4

♥ Q 8

♦ K 9 7 3

♣ K Q J T

♠ K T 2

♥ 6 4 3

♦ Q J T 6

♣ A 6 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	Pass	2 ♣	Pass
2 ♥	Pass	4 ♥	

All Pass

4 ♥ by West

♠ A if he wants the trick. But however he plays he can only make one ♠ trick when you play correctly.

For your side, 2 ♠ tricks and the two minor Aces spell defeat.

[showcards W:S3]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠ 3, dummy played the ♠ 4

Play the ♠ T.

Partner's low ♠ lead tells you that he has an honor in the suit. There are only two ♠ honors you can't see, and you know he wouldn't underlead an Ace at a suit contract. So partner holds the ♠ Q.

You can see clearly what would happen if you played Third-hand-high and put on your ♠ K. Declarer would win his ♠ A and could then set up a second ♠ trick by leading toward dummy's ♠ J.

By playing the ♠ T you force declarer to win with the

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A J 9 2

♥ T 7 5 3

♦ A 4 2

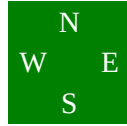
♣ 9 7

♠ 6 4

♥ K Q 2

♦ K J T 3

♣ A K 8 3



♠ Q T 8 7

♥ 9 6 4

♦ 8 7 5

♣ T 6 4

♠ K 5 3

♥ A J 8

♦ Q 9 6

♣ Q J 5 2

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

♠ 7 hold the trick. He will continue the suit, allowing you to pick up dummy's ♠ K and four ♠ winners. Along with the ♦ A you will defeat the contract.

[showcards W:S7]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠ 7, dummy played the ♠ 3

Play the ♠ 2.

Partner has led a small card, so it is surely fourth-down. That means you should automatically apply the Rule of Eleven.

11 minus 7 equals 4, so there are just 4 cards higher than the 7 between dummy, you, and declarer. **AND YOU CAN SEE ALL FOUR OF THEM.**

Declarer has no card that can beat the ♠ 7, and the only way you can beat this contract is to let partner's

If you play ANY card except your ♠ 2 on the first trick you will not be able to win four tricks in the suit because you cannot get East back into the lead. And declarer will make the contract easily.

Board 6

North Deals

E-W Vul

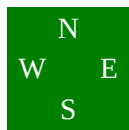
♠ K T 7 5
 ♥ 6
 ♦ K 8 3
 ♣ Q J 9 5 2

♠ 6 4

♥ K T 9 7 4 3

♦ A Q 7

♣ A T



♠ A Q J 8 2

♥ A Q J 5

♦ J 6

♣ 7 4

♠ 9 3

♥ 8 2

♦ T 9 5 4 2

♣ K 8 6 3

West

North

East

South

2♥

1♥

1♠

Pass

All Pass

Pass

4♠

4♠ by East

[showcards W:H8]

The bidding has been as shown. West's 2♥ bid shows good ♠ support with at least 10 points.

Partner led the ♥8, dummy played the ♥6

Play a small ♥.

Partner's ♥8 lead is a high spot card, either top-of-nothing, or a singleton or doubleton. He definitely does not have an honor, which means that East holds ♥ A Q J.

In other words, your ♥K is dead in the water. BUT, if you play it to this trick you hand East three ♥ tricks, while if you play a low ♥ he can only get 2 winners in the suit.

The extra winner would permit East to discard 2 of dummy's ♦ losers, and this would give East the contract.